

CDN Incident Alert: 0113. TLP: Green		Date
Title	HU Kremlin-orchestrated Information Laundering scheme subverting Hungarian media ecosystem, April 2026 Pre-Election Update	12/04/2026

Summary

- Since autumn 2021, a Hungarian-language Kremlin-partnered information laundering website, Orosz Hírek, is translating and republishing EU-sanctioned RT and Sputnik content, which makes its way into Hungarian government-aligned mainstream media.
- The operation continued unabated in the 12 months leading up the April 12, 2026 Parliamentary Elections. Hundreds of Kremlin propaganda-disinformation narratives present throughout 4+ years, examples given below.
- To degrade Ukraine and cultivate support for Russia, the operation is leveraging an existing inauthentic news site, having it machine translate the sanctioned media content, and republishing it as its own before having Hungarian government-aligned media republish it.
- Hundreds of thousands of Hungarians are consuming translated, obfuscated RT content, presented to them directly by the popular layering site, and indirectly by high-trust government-aligned mainstream media.
- Case submitted to the Hungarian branch of EDMO. Highlighting the illegal operation to Meta, Google, and X in January 2026. Only YouTube replied and removed the violating content.

Incident

Between April 6, 2025, and April 6, 2026, three Hungarian government-affiliated outlets have republished approximately 343 laundered articles, originally from the columns of the EU-sanctioned Russian outlet RT. These illegal articles were sourced directly from the Hungarian-language website Orosz Hírek, a Kremlin layering proxy which translated, republished, and worked to mask the origin of the RT articles. Orosz Hírek is a Kremlin-proxy 'copy-paste' site, having laundered approximately 1,628 pieces from RT in the observation period (36% of its yearly published corpus, up from 27.5% in 2021-2024). Orosz Hírek openly declared in their YouTube description that Ruptly, a RT-owned company, is their content provider partner.

The operation is in violation of Article 2f (1) of Council Regulation (EU) 2022/350 and Article 4g of Council Decision (CFSP) 2022/351, which outlaws the (re)distribution of RT content in any form.

Narrative

Meta-narratives: The Ukrainian government fails to uphold democratic standards and the rule of law; Degradation of the West; Russia threatened by NATO.

Sub-narratives: Ukraine is committing war crimes; Ukraine sympathises with the ideas of Nazism; Ukraine is an untrustworthy ally involved in various misdeeds; Western countries are responsible for energy shortages and rising prices.

Impact

Reach: Orosz Hírek has 225,000 followers on Facebook, with an actively engaged community, 13,900 followers on X, 20,100 subscribers on Telegram, and 7,200 subscribers on YouTube.

Outcome: Beyond its direct reach, Orosz Hírek provides a prolific avenue for Russian propaganda and disinformation into Hungarian government-aligned mainstream media.

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework) (Max 2 objectives and 4 TTPs).

Objective: [T0066: Degrade Adversary](#) – the articles promoted degrade Ukraine.

Objective: [T0136.006: Cultivate Support for Ally](#) – the operation promotes the Orbán regime and tries to reinforce the Hungarian domestic perception of Russia.

[T0098.002: Leverage Existing Inauthentic News Sites](#) – RT-owned Ruptly set up collaboration with existing fringe Orosz Hírek, and turned it into a sanctions evasion 'copy-paste' site.

[T0085.008: Machine Translated Text](#) - Orosz Hírek is machine translating content to Hungarian from RT and Sputnik.

[T0129.003: Break Association with Content](#) - Orosz Hírek also hides the origin of the RT and Sputnik content, publishing it as its own original content.

[T0117: Attract Traditional Media](#) – Leveraging Orosz Hírek to inject laundered content into Hungarian

Recommendations and Actions Taken DISRUPT Framework

Actions Taken: [Sanctioned content](#) – Reported the content to the social media platforms Meta, Google, and X, asking them to address the systemic sanction violation through geofencing or takedown. Google took action, taking down violating videos. Other actors did not reply (01/2026);

The contributor is collaborating with the Hungarian Digital Media Observatory (Lakmusz) to author an exposé article, both covering Orosz Hírek, and complicit Hungarian government aligned media.

Recommendations: Inform complicit Hungarian-government aligned media of the sanctions evasion; Potentially escalate to the national regulator to go after complicit mainstream media - political pushback expected.

Report	Threat Actor	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	FIMI Assessment
N/A	Russia	Databases	Domonkos D Kovacs, Independent Researcher	Website, Facebook, YouTube, Telegram	X, High certainty

Delete before sending!

One-page Template Guide

[TLP](#): Amber+Strict

When we initially started developing the CDN, we spoke with responders about the challenges they face in their work. One of the key points raised was that they were being flooded by reports and findings, using different formats, definitions, and methodologies.

In those conversations, the methodology and one-page template were born.

The core purpose of the one-page template is to give a clear and quick standardised overview of a case or report, allowing a responder to quickly decide if it is relevant for them to read the full report, pass it on to someone else, or ignore it.

The one-page template can be longer than one page in specific circumstances, especially when there are a lot of contributors that need to be credited. We recommend that you do not pass two pages. You can always link to a longer report with all the details of your case.

The template's different components are explained below. The same text can be found in the one-page template.

Only the header, summary, and incident section of the incident alert are obligatory for you to fill out. You can also work with others to complete the other sections of the incident alert, including asking us for help. While the template comes with instructions on how to use it, consider these as recommendations. At times, parts of the information we request do not exist or are not within the scope of your research, which is fine.

Feel free to contact Sam (Saman Nazari) if you need any help filling out the template.

Header

CDN Incident Alert: 0001. TLP: CLEAR			Date
Title	DE	Use the same title as the report. If no report is present, a suggestion is to use the format: Actor, doing what to who	28/06/2024

Each header has 6 components:

1. The type of template, in this case, a Counter Disinformation Network Incident Alert.

Currently, we use Incident Alert, to indicate that we are reporting on an urgent actionable case, and Report Summary, summarising a larger report not of an urgent nature.

2. The number of the one-pager, in this case 0001.
3. Traffic Light Protocol – indicating how publicly the one-pager can be shared.

TLP: Red - Not for disclosure, restricted to individual participants only.

TLP: Amber+Strict - Limited disclosure, restricted to participants' organization.

TLP: Amber - Limited disclosure, restricted to participants' organization and its clients

TLP: Green - Limited disclosure, restricted to the IO/disinformation-countering community

TLP: Clear - Disclosure is not limited.

4. The country or region being targeted, in this case, Germany (DE). Can also be larger geographical areas, like the EU.
5. A title. Up to you to decide.
6. The date of the incident's publication, in this case, 28/06/2024.

Body

Summary

Summary

- On June 1st, 300 social media assets (X & Meta) and 10 websites tied to China flooded hashtags to target an MEP.
- The Influence Operation (IO) promoted a narrative claiming that the MEP was a terrorist and eats dogs
- The IO employed a network of fabricated accounts masquerading as German locals.
- The IO reached 2.5 million people and targeted primarily German speakers in Germany.
- Meta and X contacted, counter-narrative promoting MEP local connections, name and shame campaign.

While this will be the first text facing the reader, it will be the last text you will write. This section of the one-pager is meant to summarise the rest of the alert. Each sentence should be a summary of the different parts of the one-pager. There are no strict rules around how the different sentences should look, but we recommend that you write the summary in the same order as the information is presented in the rest of the one-pager.

When possible, we believe that the most efficient way of using the summary is to in the first sentence try to clearly include the platforms used in the influence operation, in this case, X and Meta, the size of the influence operation, in this case, 300 social media assets and 10 websites, who is behind it, in this case, China, and its targets, in this case, a Green MEP.

The second line can indicate the key narrative.

The third line can indicate the key DISARM tactics and techniques.

The fourth line can indicate the impact.

The last line can indicate actions taken and recommendations.

Incident

The incident section of an alert should begin with the date of the first observed activity or piece of content. It should specify when someone did something to say something to whom and the reason for doing so. As long as you include these components, it's up to you to decide what format of writing works for you.

Incident – When, Who did what, to say what, to whom, why?

On June 24, 100 Facebook pages flooded the hashtag #eu-elections with 10 different racist memes ridiculing the Green MEP x (e.g. 1, 2, 3).

Accounts involved are likely tied to Chinese Coordinated Inauthentic Behaviour (CIB) network. Spamouflage - see CIB matrix. This influence operation likely is a reaction to the Green MEP x making a statement calling out China's human right violations against minority group x on June 21 (4).

On June 25, 10 different websites, named after German towns, published 10 articles with the meme, (e.g. 5, 6, 7). This could indicate that the target audience of the campaign is small towns in Germany.

On June 26, 200 Twitter accounts shared the articles within 30 min, using 5 hashtags named after German cities (e.g. 8, 9, 10).

This influence operation is likely trying to discredit the MEP to damage her chances to get elected.

The MEP is a refugee from Syria (11) and has been targeted in the past by extremist groups (IA 0000).

In this section, you can provide contextual information about who is behind the activity, and why it is happening right now. You can specify which platforms are being used by the threat actor and the scale of things, e.g. how many accounts did something.

When possible, you can reference old cases including the same target or the same threat actor using the same technique.

Make sure to have in-text references for all your claims using archived links. When not possible due to the amount of links or type of evidence, attach a link to an external document with the evidence included. You can also use Hunchly to record the evidence.

If the one-pager is summarising a larger report, feel free to leave out the sources as long as you provide them in the report itself.

Narrative

Narrative - separate with ;

Meta narrative: Degradation of the West; Technological progress endangers public safety.

Sub-narrative: German government is failing its citizens by supporting Ukraine over domestic issues;

Sub-narrative: EVs are unreliable and prone to explosions and accidents

Meta narrative:

Sub-narratives:

To describe the narratives, please include the overall narrative, which we call the meta-narrative. Then indicate the sub-narratives building up that meta narrative. Maintain the structure that can be found in the narrative section.

We recommend that you focus on one or two meta-narratives. You can also choose to focus on only meta- or sub-narratives, depending on the scale and scope of the case you are covering.

A larger influence operation such as Doppelganger can involve many narratives. You can either reference the key ones that stand out or are new, or list them all if you have the space. Remember that you can always publish a larger report with all the narratives in them and that the alert should act as a summary.

You should avoid having overlap between these narratives.

Meta narratives are overarching ideas or concepts that the threat actors are trying to sell us, such as the West is falling, U.S. is corrupt, and the government is not prioritising its' citizens.

Sub naratives are the smaller narratives that build up the meta narratives, such as U.S. government officials gives government contracts to their friends, the government priorisises funding refugees instead of helping their population, the government is prioritising trans people instead of retired people.

As we lack a unified narrative framework for the community, we want to start listing the narratives we see in our research and start developing a common taxonomy.

Together with CDN partners, we are working towards a Narrative Taxonomy.

Impact

Impact

Reach: Social media posts 10k likes and 1 million views on Twitter. 20k likes and 1.5 million views on Facebook. One of the articles were quoted in Frankfurt local newspaper (11).

Impact assessments are tricky. We are using two proxies:

1. Reach – views, interactions, shares, and followers.
2. Outcome outlines when an operation managed to break into public discourse or cause offline events.

Key Objectives and Behaviours

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

Objective: [Defend Reputation](#) and [Smear](#) – counter-narratives to dismiss criticism and attack their opponents.
[Purchase Targeted Advertisements](#) – The pages purchased ads to deliver their content to European audiences.
[Develop Memes](#) – Global Times used memes in their ad campaigns.
[Co-Opt Trusted Individuals](#) – Ads from both entities used scholars and experts to deliver their operational narratives.
[News Outlet Persona](#) – China has positioned these two influence operations as news outlets.
[Conceal Sponsorship](#) – Global Times and CGTN Europe are not filling out the disclaimer required by Meta for advertisers on social issues, elections, and politics, hence not fully declaring who is paying for the ads.

Outline the key objectives (max 2), and manipulative behaviours (max 4) using the [DISARM Framework](#).

Focus on the key manipulative behaviours that made the influence operation successful or interesting to study. Please link to the page of the technique so the reader also can read the definition of the TTP.

Techniques can be used to observe the vulnerabilities used in influence operations, helping us shape our recommendations.

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Recommendations and Actions Taken DISRUPT Framework [here](#) (end each with a ;).

Actions Taken: [Sanctioned content](#) – Reported the content to the social media platforms as a sanctions violation (03/04/2026).

Recommendations:

Outline which actions you took to counter the issue yourself, e.g. reporting the network to Meta and X. You can use the Taxonomy of the DISRUPT Framework.

By recording when this action was taken, we can also record when and whether the platforms responded or took any actions, allowing us to evaluate the platforms based on if they are following up on their commitments. This data can be sent to the DSA enforcement team at the European Commission, allowing them to take action against the platforms if they do not follow through on their obligations.

Also, provide other recommendations that come to mind, including potential next steps, using the DISRUPT Framework.

You can also provide recommendations free from the framework itself.

Alliance4Europe is happy to help you promote your report to responders who potentially can act upon your findings.

Footer

Report	Threat Actor	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	FIMI Assessment
Link	E.g. Russia, China. etc.	Reference/link to report, external document. or folder.	Name. organisation	E.g. Facebook, X, YouTube.	E.g. Low certainty Medium certainty High certainty

The report section of the footer allows us to link to a larger report that the incident alert has summarised.

Threat actor outlines which threat actors are involved in the case (e.g. Russia, China etc).

Evidence should contain links to external evidence sheets.

Authors include all contributors to the report and their organisations.

Platforms include which platforms were used to conduct the influence operation.

FIMI Assessment allows you to indicate your certainty around whether the case is Foreign Information Manipulation and Interference (FIMI). This component is a contribution by EUDisinfoLab.